

scripts/inject-helix-inheritance-block.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-14 (1.2.23 cycle) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script documentation mandate) + Lava §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance) + §6.AD-debt item 1 (per-scope CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / CONSTITUTION.md propagation)

Overview

Idempotent debt-closure tool that injects the standard `## INHERITED FROM constitution/<File>.md` pointer-block into per-scope CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / CONSTITUTION.md files across the Lava project. Used during the §6.AD HelixConstitution incorporation cycle (1.2.23, 2026-05-14) to mechanically propagate the inheritance pattern to 54 in-scope files in one pass.

Prerequisites

- git ≥ 2.30 in PATH
- HelixConstitution submodule mounted at `./constitution/` (the script's pointer-block REFERS to `constitution/<File>.md`; the submodule must exist for the references to resolve)

Usage

Apply to all in-scope files (default)

`scripts/inject-helix-inheritance-block.sh`

Walks the canonical scope ($16 \times$ submodules/*/
{CLAUDE, AGENTS, CONSTITUTION}.md + $3 \times$ lava-api-go/
{CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, CONSTITUTION.md} + core/CLAUDE.md + app/
CLAUDE.md + feature/CLAUDE.md = 54 files), and for each:

1. If the file already carries a `## INHERITED FROM constitution/` heading
→ skip with ✓ already present

2. Else find the first H1 heading (# Title), inject the pointer-block immediately after it, report + injected after line N
3. If no H1 found → skip with $\triangle$ no H1 – manual review needed

Apply to a specific file

```
scripts/inject-helix-inheritance-block.sh path/to/some/CLAUDE.md
```

Only that file is processed. Useful when adding a new submodule or new per-scope doc.

Apply to multiple specific files

```
scripts/inject-helix-inheritance-block.sh file1.md file2.md  
file3.md
```

Inputs

Argument	Required?	Description
[files...]	no	Specific files to process (default: walk canonical scope)

Outputs

- Per-file modification logged to stdout (+ added / ✓ already present / $\triangle$ errored)
- Summary line: Summary: added=N skipped-already-present=M errored=K
- Exit 0 if errored=0; exit 1 otherwise

Side-effects

- Modifies in-place via head/cat/tail + mv (no in-place sed; portable across BSD + GNU)
- Idempotent: re-running produces no diff once all files carry the block
- Does NOT commit, does NOT push, does NOT update submodule pins

File-type-aware target resolution

The pointer-block's target file matches the consuming file's basename:

Consuming file	Pointer target
*CLAUDE.md	constitution/CLAUDE.md
*AGENTS.md	constitution/AGENTS.md
*CONSTITUTION.md	constitution/Constitution.md (note capitalization — HelixConstitution names it Constitution.md, not CONSTITUTION.md)

Edge cases

File has no H1 heading

The script reports `△ no H1 heading — skip (manual review needed)` and continues. Common cause: the file starts with a YAML front-matter block. Fix: add an H1 heading, or manually inject the block.

File has a comment block / banner before the H1

The injection happens after the H1, so any pre-H1 banner content (license headers, etc.) is preserved as-is.

Re-running after manual edits to the block

The idempotency check is `grep -qE '^## INHERITED FROM constitution/'`. If the heading was preserved (even if its body was edited), the script will skip. To force re-injection, delete the heading line first.

Internal behaviour

For each in-scope file:

1. Idempotency: `grep -qE '^## INHERITED FROM constitution/'` — if present, skip
2. H1 detection: `awk '/^# / {print NR; exit}'` — find the first H1 line number
3. Block composition: `pointer_block_for "$BASENAME"` writes the file-type-aware block to a tempfile
4. Injection: `head -n H1 file > tmp; cat block >> tmp; tail -n + (H1+1) file >> tmp; mv tmp file`

The head/cat/tail/mv approach is intentional — BSD awk rejects multi-line strings via `-v`, so pure-awk injection is not portable. The tempfile approach works on both BSD and GNU userlands.

Related scripts

- `scripts/check-constitution.sh` — verifies the propagation is complete; suggests this script when missing
- `scripts/commit_all.sh` — used to commit the inject results; do NOT auto-commit from this script

Cross-references

- `Lava CLAUDE.md §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance)` clause 4 — the propagation requirement
- `Lava CLAUDE.md §6.AD-debt item 1` — debt closure context
- `HelixConstitution CLAUDE.md "How inheritance works"` — the prescribed pattern